

# Wabi Beds

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*Raw wood, solid stone, zero two the same — premium beds that sell on their story.*

## What It Is

A handcrafted furniture brand making wabi-sabi style beds: headboards carved from a single slab of natural wood, frames resting on solid stone blocks, every imperfection left visible and celebrated. Because each piece is genuinely one-of-a-kind, you sell artisan furniture at premium, design-store prices from inexpensive raw material.

## How It Makes Money

You sell statement bed frames and headboards directly to design-conscious homeowners, interior designers, and boutique hotels/short-term-rental owners. Margins are high because the value is in the look and story, not the material cost. Add-on revenue from matching nightstands, benches, and consoles in the same style, plus designer trade accounts that re-order.

## Startup Costs

- Slab wood (live-edge walnut, oak, acacia, suar): \$150–\$600 per headboard slab; buy in bulk from a local mill or import suar/acacia slabs from Indonesia/Vietnam
- Stone blocks (basalt, granite offcuts): often free-to-\$80 from stone yards as remnants
- Basic woodworking kit (track saw, sander, router, chisels, food-safe oil/epoxy): \$2,500–\$5,000
- Workshop space (garage or small unit): \$0–\$1,200/mo
- Optional China/Asia sourcing of finished wabi-sabi frames to resell (Alibaba: "live edge wood slab bed frame"): \$180–\$450 landed per unit, MOQ 5–20
- Photography + Shopify site + branding: \$600–\$1,500
- First-month ads/content: \$500–\$1,000
- **Total to launch (build-yourself): \$4,000–\$9,000** — or ~\$3,000 if you import-and-resell first

## The Numbers

- Material + finish cost per bed (build-yourself): \$250–\$700
- Sell price: \$2,200–\$4,500 (king-size statement pieces hit \$5,000+)
- Profit per bed: \$1,600–\$3,800
- Import-and-resell model: ~\$350 landed, sell \$1,800–\$2,800 → \$1,400–\$2,400 profit
- Sell 6–10 beds/month = **\$12,000–\$30,000 profit/month**, plus designer trade orders that buy 3–5 at once.

## How To Start

1. Source 3–5 live-edge slabs from a local mill or imported supplier and collect stone remnants from a countertop fabricator.
2. Build two showpiece beds — one queen, one king — finishing the wood with food-safe hardwax oil to keep the raw look.
3. Shoot them in a styled bedroom setting; the "no two are the same" story is your entire marketing.
4. List on Shopify + Etsy with build-time and made-to-order messaging to justify premium pricing.
5. Pitch local interior designers and high-end Airbnb owners with a trade discount for repeat orders.

6. Post the carving/build process on Instagram and TikTok — process videos sell artisan furniture.
7. Offer made-to-order with a 30–50% deposit so customers fund the materials before you build.

## Where To Get Customers

Interior designers and home stagers (trade accounts); boutique hotels and luxury Airbnb owners; Instagram, Pinterest, and TikTok (process + reveal videos); Etsy and 1stDibs for high-intent buyers; local high-end home shows and design markets.

## Pro Tips

- Sell made-to-order with a deposit so you never carry inventory and the customer's money buys the slab.
- Photograph the grain and stone up close — buyers pay for "this exact piece," so emphasize uniqueness in every listing.
- Lock a designer-trade program early; one interior designer furnishing homes and rentals can become a recurring multi-bed buyer.